

The Physical Field Kit

Cards for capturing meaning on paper, in the language it was spoken.

Context Cards 5 cards · Module 1

Interview Cards 7 cards · Module 2

Reflection Cards 4 cards · after each session

Researcher Positionality Card 1 card · Module 1

Blank Meaning Cards 4 cards · Module 2

Printing and using the kit

- Every card is 6 × 4 in (152 × 102 mm). Print at 100%, double-sided.
- If a back is upside down, switch between flip on long edge and flip on short edge.
- Use card stock (200 to 300 gsm) for cards that will be handled in the field.
- Keep one Meaning Card per moment. Do not squeeze two moments onto one card.
- Cards can be written on in any language. Do not translate exact words on the front.

People and guide

- Who am I spending time with, and who is my local guide?
- How does my guide know this place, and whom might they steer me away from?
- Who lives or works here differently from the people I have met so far?

DATE _____ SETTING _____

WHAT I NOTICED *(People and guide)*

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins or other markings on the paper.

Routines and relationships

- What happens here at different times of the day?
- Who depends on whom? Who speaks for whom?
- Where do people go for help, and who do they ask first?

DATE _____ SETTING _____

WHAT I NOTICED *(Routines and relationships)*

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Language and communication

- Which languages are used here, by whom, and with whom?
- Where do people switch language or register, and what seems to trigger it?
- Which words, exclamations, or gestures do I not yet fully understand?

DATE _____ SETTING _____

WHAT I NOTICED *(Language and communication)*

[illegible]

Possible meanings and their limits

- What do I think this means?
- What would make me wrong?
- Who could tell me, and how would I ask?

DATE	SETTING
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WHAT I NOTICED *(Possible meanings and their limits)*

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Glossary seed

- The term or phrase, in the language it was used.
- Who said it, where, and to whom.
- What I think it means, and what I am unsure about.

Feeds the provisional codebook, glossary, and interview guide.

DATE	SETTING
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WHAT I NOTICED *(Glossary seed)*

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Ask for consent

Audio and video

- Say who you are, what this is for, who will hear or see the recording, and when it will be deleted.
- Ask about audio and video separately. Either can be declined.
- Remind them they can skip any question or stop at any time.

☐ Audio ☐ Video ☐ Notes only Date: _____

PARTICIPANT CODE _____ DATE _____

NOTES AND EXACT WORDS (*Ask for consent*)

[illegible]

Begin with daily life

Put them at ease

- “Tell me about yesterday, from the time you woke up.”
- “Tell me about the last time you had to sort out something official.”
- Follow their stories. The aim is to learn how they live and to make them comfortable.

PARTICIPANT CODE _____ DATE _____

NOTES AND EXACT WORDS *(Begin with daily life)*

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Notice

A phrase, an action, or a pause

- A significant phrase (a micro comment), an action (an expression or gesture), or a pause.
- Write down the exact words, what you saw, and how long the pause lasted.
- Do not interpret yet. Start a Meaning Card.

PARTICIPANT CODE _____ DATE _____

NOTES AND EXACT WORDS (*Notice*)

[illegible]

Probe heavy moments

Branch: if it is hard to understand

- If an emotion, expression, or gesture is heavy or hard to understand, ask what it is like.
- Invite a picture, a saying, or a comparison, in their own language.
- Offer a spoken idiom only after they have tried, and ask whether it fits.

PARTICIPANT CODE

DATE _____

NOTES AND EXACT WORDS *(Probe heavy moments)*

[illegible]

Ask what it meant to them

Before you share your guess

- “Earlier you said ... What did you mean by that?”
- Ask in their language first. Write down their words.
- Share your guess only after they have answered.

PARTICIPANT CODE _____ DATE _____

NOTES AND EXACT WORDS (*Ask what it meant to them*)

[illegible]

Record correction and reaction

Where you were wrong is data

- If they correct or disagree with your guess, write it down as they say it.
- Note how they react: a laugh, a silence, pushback.
- Mark the correction status on the Meaning Card.

PARTICIPANT CODE _____ DATE _____

NOTES AND EXACT WORDS (*Record correction and reaction*)

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Optional: observe a task

A task or service experience

- If needed, ask whether you can watch them do a task or use a service.
- Notice, note, and ask in the same way as in the interview.
- Capture each moment on its own Meaning Card.

PARTICIPANT CODE _____ DATE _____

NOTES AND EXACT WORDS (Optional: observe a task)

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What surprised me?

- What did I not expect to hear, see, or feel?
- What does that tell me about what I assumed?

PARTICIPANT CODE _____ DATE _____

MY REFLECTION (*What surprised me?*)

[illegible]

Where did I assume?

- Which of my guesses came from my own background rather than from what was said?
- Where did I finish a sentence in my head?

PARTICIPANT CODE _____ DATE _____

MY REFLECTION *(Where did I assume?)*

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What crossed a language boundary?

- Which moments were spoken in one language and noted in another?
- Who interpreted, and what might they have shaped?
- Do I have all four Fidelity tags for each: source language, who interpreted, rendering, second reader?

PARTICIPANT CODE _____ DATE _____

MY REFLECTION *(What crossed a language boundary?)*

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What needs another look?

- Which Meaning Cards need a second reader, a translation review, or another question?
- What new questions should go into the next round?

New questions feed back into Module 1.

PARTICIPANT CODE _____ DATE _____

MY REFLECTION *(What needs another look?)*

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RESEARCHER _____ DATE _____

Languages I speak, understand, and do not understand.

How my background differs from, or overlaps with, the people I am talking to.

How participants may see me, and what that might lead them to say or leave unsaid.

What I treat as normal that may not be.

What I may find hard to notice.

Revisit at the end of fieldwork

What changed in how I see my own position?

DATE REVISITED

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and extend across the width of the page. There are approximately 20 lines visible. The paper has rounded corners on the left side and a small tab-like cutout at the top center.

MOMENT ID

SETTING

TIME

WHAT WAS HAPPENING

EXACT WORDS (ORIGINAL LANGUAGE) *(as spoken, do not translate)*

WHAT WAS OBSERVED

RESEARCHER'S GUESS AT MEANING *(a guess, not a finding)*

WHAT WAS ASKED TO CONFIRM

PARTICIPANT'S EXPLANATION

CORRECTION STATUS

☐ Confirmed ☐ Corrected ☐ Disagreed ☐ Not yet checked

ANOTHER POSSIBLE MEANING

TRANSLATION REVIEW FLAG

☐ A language collaborator still needs to check the translation

SENSITIVE TO REUSE

☐ Quoting or sharing this could expose the participant

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